Citizen Grievance Redressal Policy 2024

Sahyadripur Municipal Corporation

1. Purpose

This policy sets out how the Sahyadripur Municipal Corporation receives, routes, resolves and reviews citizen complaints. It applies to all departments and all 20 wards. The corporation commits to a transparent, time-bound grievance process in which every complaint receives a tracking number and every citizen can follow its status.

2. Service level agreements

Each complaint category has a maximum resolution time counted from the moment the complaint is registered:

Water Supply Department: 48 hours for complaints in its category.

Drainage & Sewerage Department: 72 hours for complaints in its category.

Roads & Maintenance Department: 120 hours for complaints in its category.

Solid Waste Management Department: 24 hours for complaints in its category.

Street Lighting Department: 72 hours for complaints in its category.

Encroachment Removal Department: 168 hours for complaints in its category.

Public Health Department: 48 hours for complaints in its category.

Electricity Department: 24 hours for complaints in its category.

Parks & Gardens Department: 168 hours for complaints in its category.

Pollution Control Department: 48 hours for complaints in its category.

A complaint that is not resolved within its SLA is recorded as an SLA breach and is escalated automatically.

3. Escalation matrix

Level 1: Ward Officer, at registration. Level 2: Department Head, when 100 percent of the SLA has elapsed. Level 3: Additional Commissioner, when 200 percent of the SLA has elapsed. Level 4: Municipal Commissioner, when 300 percent of the SLA has elapsed or when the complaint concerns a public health risk. Complaints reported by more than 25 citizens within 7 days about the same location are treated as a cluster and escalated directly to Level 2.

4. Feedback and reopening

After resolution the citizen is invited to rate the service from 1 to 5. A rating of 2 or lower reopens the complaint for review by the Ward Officer within 48 hours. Departments with an average rating below 3.0 in a quarter must submit an improvement plan to the Commissioner.

5. Data use and privacy

Citizen names and phone numbers are used only to process the complaint. They are masked in analytical reports and dashboards and must never be shared with third-party services. Analytical summaries use anonymised text only.

6. Review

The Commissioner reviews grievance performance monthly using resolution rate, average resolution time, SLA compliance, repeat complaint rate and citizen satisfaction. Wards in the bottom quartile for SLA compliance for two consecutive months receive a corrective action review.